



System Design

Given a customer landscape and their requirements, evaluate business, technical, and architectural considerations that support the defined org strategy.

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After studying this topic, you should be able to:

-  Define the two types of org strategies.
-  Describe the different architectural, business, and technical considerations that influence the org strategy.
-  Evaluate the customer enterprise landscape and recommend suitable org strategies based on specific requirements.



Introduction

In today's rapidly evolving business landscape, organizations leveraging Salesforce face critical decisions regarding their org strategy, primarily whether to opt for a **single-org or a multi-org strategy**. This decision significantly impacts an organization's ability to innovate, collaborate, and grow.

Choosing an appropriate org strategy requires a comprehensive understanding of various factors, including **business objectives**, **technical requirements**, and **architectural considerations**. For instance, the **enterprise architecture operating model** is important to consider for an org strategy. By carefully assessing these aspects, organizations can tailor their Salesforce environment strategy to their unique needs.



Salesforce Org Strategy

Org Strategy

A Salesforce org strategy refers to a plan of how to use Salesforce for the business best and provides a consistent set of processes and procedures.

Single Org & Multi-Org Strategies

Choosing between a single-org and a multi-org strategy is a critical decision when planning a Salesforce implementation and requires several aspects to be considered.



Architectural Considerations

The enterprise architecture model and integration strategy are important architectural considerations for choosing a particular org strategy.

Business Considerations

Choosing a specific org strategy can be influenced by certain business considerations related to funding overhead, lines of business, etc.

Technical Considerations

Technical considerations are related to aspects such as change management, data security, compliance, collaboration, etc.

Salesforce Org Strategy

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Salesforce Org Strategy

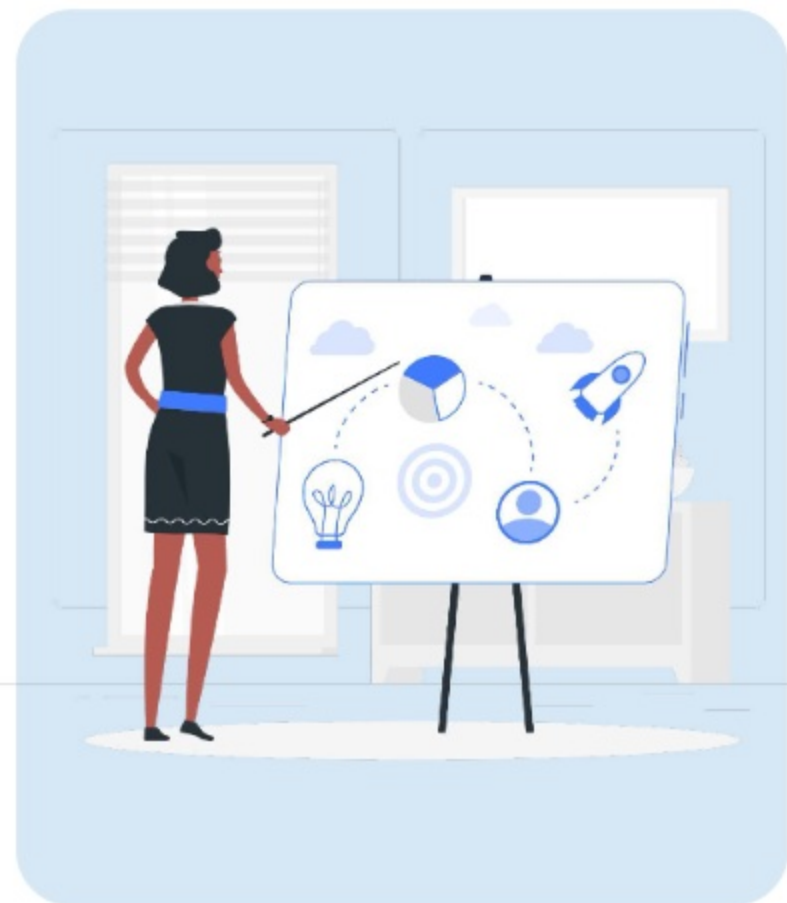
An org strategy is a **plan of how to best use Salesforce** for the business.

❖ ORG ARCHITECTURE

The underlying org architecture is used in **Salesforce solutions** and **aligns with the business needs** to maximize value.

❖ SOLUTIONS

It provides **consistent set of processes and procedures** for **building solutions** on the Salesforce platform.



Single-Org vs. Multi-Org Strategy

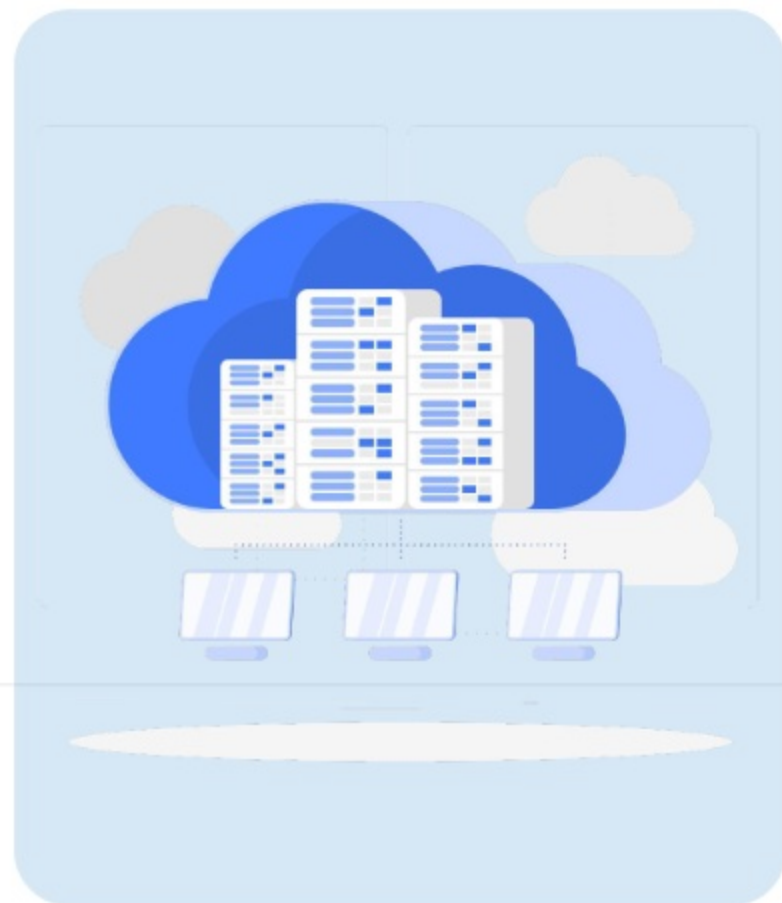
When planning a Salesforce implementation, one of the critical decisions is choosing between a **single-org** and a **multi-org strategy**.

❖ IMPACT

The org strategy impacts the **scalability, complexity, governance, and overall architecture** of the Salesforce environment.

❖ DECISION

Choosing the org strategy is not just a **technical decision**, but one that aligns closely with the **business strategies, operational models, and long-term objectives**.



Org Strategy Considerations

When choosing between a single-org and a multi-org strategy, **architectural, business and technical considerations** should be taken into account.

❖ ARCHITECTURAL

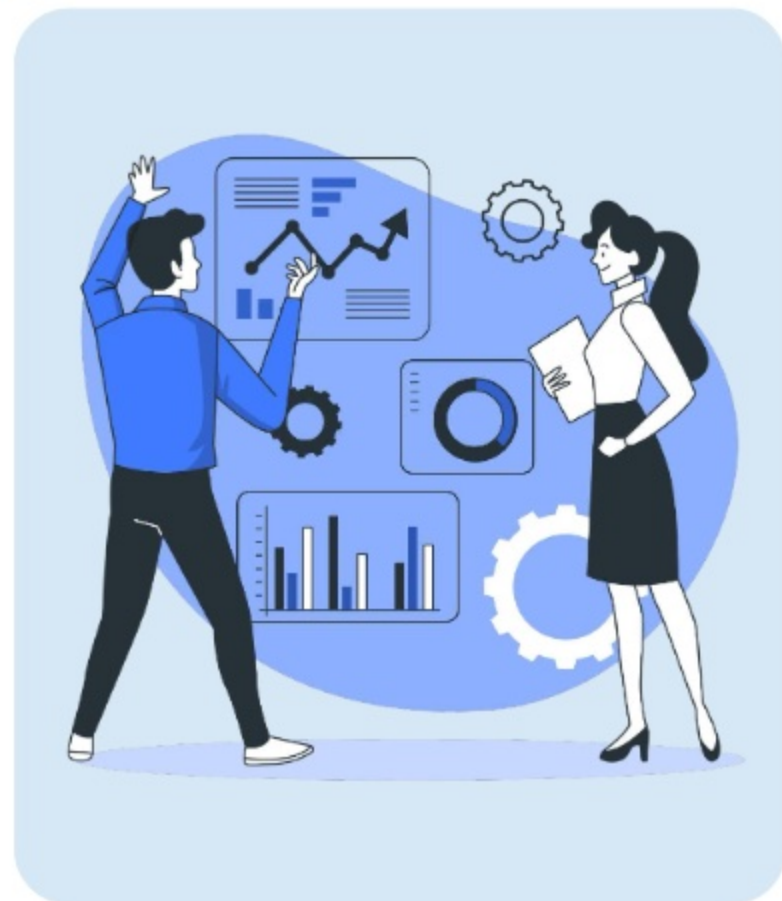
Architectural aspects such as **operating model** and **integration strategy** for business processes and data need to be considered.

❖ BUSINESS

Business considerations are related to aspects such as **funding, control, lines of business, overhead of multiple orgs**, and **unified view of data**.

❖ TECHNICAL

Technical considerations are related to **change management, data security, compliance, collaboration, technical roles and responsibilities**, and **technical limitations**.



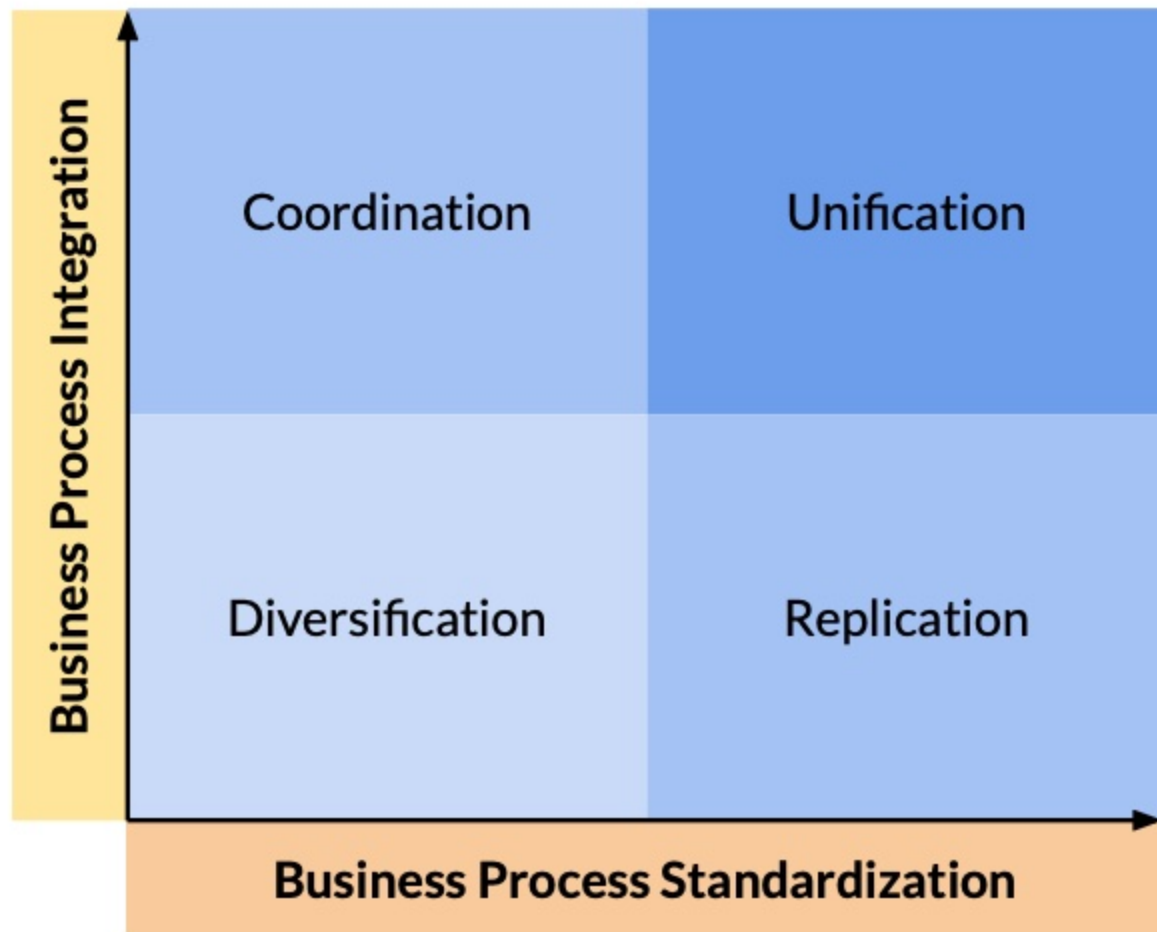
Architectural Considerations

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Enterprise Architecture Operating Model

There are **four** possible enterprise architecture operating models based on the degree of **business process integration** and **business process standardization**.



Diversification

The diversification model applies to companies with **low business process integration** and **low business process standardization**.



Companies that use the diversification model have **independent business units with different customers and expertise**. Examples include Johnson and Johnson, Carlson Companies, and GE.



The key IT capability is **providing economies of scale without limiting independence**.



Such companies usually have **multiple orgs** since the consolidation of multiple business processes and data models into one org is very complicated.



Diversified business units are usually **not accustomed to working in the same space** as the other lines of business.

Replication

The replication model applies to companies with **low business process integration** and **high business process standardization**.



Companies that use the replication model have **independent but similar business units**. Examples include Marriott, CEMEX, and ING DIRECT.



The key IT capability is **providing standard infrastructure and application components for global efficiencies**.



Such companies can have **multiple orgs**. A **managed package** should be deployed from a central org into all the replicated business units.



Local control/administration can be provided while **maintaining the predefined standard business processes**.

Coordination

The coordination model applies to companies with **high business process integration** and **low business process standardization**.



Companies that use the coordination model have **unique business units with a need to know each other's transactions**.

Examples include Merrill Lynch, Toyota Motor Marketing Europe, and Metlife.



The key IT capability is **access to shared data, through standard technology interfaces**.



Such companies should have **as few orgs as possible**. A web services integration strategy can be utilized, but the **potential value is much higher in a single org**.



A **proper governance strategy** and an **effective service delivery strategy** are necessary to keep the multiple lines of business satisfied.

Unification

The unification model applies to companies with **high business process integration** and **high business process standardization**.



Companies that use the unification model have a **single business with global process standards and global data access**.

Examples include Delta Airlines, Dow Chemical, and Pepsi Americas.



The key IT capability is **enterprise systems reinforcing standard processes and providing global data access**.



Such companies should have **as few orgs as possible**. This enterprise architecture operating model is the most suitable for a **single-org strategy**.

Integration Strategy

It is important to define the strategy for the **integration of business processes** and **data across multiple orgs.**



Enterprise Service Bus can be considered for a **decoupled** integration architecture.



Salesforce Connect can be utilized for integration around master data that are only needed for **reference.**



Hub & spoke architecture is suitable to share master data in a central org with other orgs.



The use of **managed packages** can be considered to deploy functionality from the hub org to the spoke orgs.



All the necessary data can be pushed to a separate org for **reporting and/or collaboration.**

Business Considerations

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Funding & Scope of Control

Funding sources and **control scope** in a company might dictate the org strategy, making it necessary to emphasize **coordination** and **data architecture awareness**.



The architect needs **to coordinate** and **be aware** of the entire Salesforce community in the company.



The **required data objects** in each org should be identified. Each org should be aware of any **duplicated data objects**.



The company should be pushed toward setting up a **Global Center of Excellence (CoE)**.



A **Reference Architecture** should be designed and built by the CoE, defining where and when an additional org is reasonable or necessary.



Architecture decisions should be made at the correct level of the company.

Lines of Business (LOBs)

Having multiple lines of business is **not a good reason** to have **separate orgs**. **Challenges increase** with more lines of business.



A **CoE** should be set up to manage the stakeholders and articulate a clear roadmap of functionality releases across the LOBs.



LOBs can be allowed to make their own changes through the use of **delegated administration** and a **tiered data architecture**.



A **license tax** can be established to fund **development and maintenance resources** to support all the LOBs.



Smaller LOBs may be pooled around a CoE and centralized resources while the **larger LOBs** can fund and support their own org.

Overhead of Multiple Orgs

Costs increase with multiple orgs due to **licensing, integration, and management overhead**.



If users need to access multiple orgs, **licensing costs** increase.



Third-party licensing costs also increase depending on the solution.



Integrating data and business processes across the orgs increases integration costs.



Multiple sandboxes and release cycles in a multi-org design increase the environment management costs.



The need for **SSO** becomes necessary to improve user experience and avoid wasting support time.

Customer 360 & Global Case Management

Having **customer 360** or **global case management requirements** is often the deciding factor when it comes to choosing a **single-org strategy**.

SINGLE-ORG STRATEGY

Single org strategy is suitable when customer data need to be unified in a single org for a 360-degree view.



MULTI-ORG STRATEGY

Multi-org strategy can support these requirements, but with added complexity and cost. A hub/spoke or reporting hub can be utilized.

Technical Considerations

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Complexity of Multiple Lines of Business (LOBs)

Designing a **single Salesforce org** to support **multiple lines of business** introduces a lot of **complexity**.



Good naming standards should be implemented across the data model, configuration design, and custom code.



It is **difficult to design, maintain, and refactor security and sharing features**, including profiles, permission sets, role hierarchy, sharing model, and public groups.



Apex design must be **very mature** to support a large enterprise model. There should be a **strict separation of concerns**, and a technical architect should **oversee** all aspects of the org.



A data architect should be employed to **manage the design and maintenance of the data model**, as it can become **much more complex and controversial** as the **scope** increases.

Effective Change Management

Parallel work streams can make supporting many initiatives at once in a **single org** difficult. An **effective governance model** is often required.



The **business architecture** and **common standards** of all the Salesforce instances across the enterprise should be managed by a **global CoE**.



The **governance committee** of each org should perform product management and set direction and priority within each org. **Roles and responsibilities** and a **RACI matrix** should be defined for changes.



The **architectural review board** of an org should actively **design, review, and approve technical changes** to the environment, including configuration, data model, and custom code.



Tiered administration teams in each org enable the LOBs to make some changes by themselves without requiring production releases.

Regulatory, Compliance, and Security Requirements

Regulatory, compliance, and security requirements may necessitate **separate orgs** due to the need for **data isolation**.



Due to certain factors, **data isolation** is necessary in some industries like **healthcare and financial services**.



The security requirements may differ for **Personally Identifiable Information (PII)** than other business data.



Complex encryption requirements, IP requirements, and **confidential business data** of some LOBs may necessitate separate orgs.

Chatter

If users are **spread across multiple orgs**, social collaboration can be a **big hindrance** due to the absence of **cross-org Chatter support**.

SOLUTIONS

Partner solutions and **custom development options** are available for cross-org collaboration, but they can be very complicated to implement correctly.



SCOPE

Chatter should not be the main driver for the org strategy, but it is important to understand the **scope of social collaboration** desired across the enterprise.

Development, Administration, and Release Management

Who will **modify and maintain orgs** is an important consideration for choosing a suitable org strategy.



Having **multiple development teams** in the same org **increases overhead** and **governance complexity**.



Having **multiple teams** in the same org requires a **robust environment management and release strategy**.



A **dedicated deployment manager** should be employed to handle the **movement of code and metadata** across the environments.



The **number of true system administrators** should be as few as possible. Using **custom profiles and permission sets** is critical.



Multiple orgs may need **their own release management processes** or **complicate existing ones**.

Support & Service Management

Different **layers of support** are necessary to consider for each **line of business**.



Each line of business should have its own **tier 0 support layer** for handling **basic support requests**.



There should be a **single service desk** and **entry point** for all the **tier 1 Salesforce support**.



Each org should have its own **tier 2 and 3 support teams** to address more **complex issues** and **troubleshooting**.

Org Limits

Org limitations may necessitate using **multiple orgs**.

FRESH LIMITS

A **new org** offers a **fresh set of limits** that can help get around issues that cannot be solved in a single org.



INCREASING LIMITS

Before **setting up a new org**, Salesforce should be consulted because it may be possible to **increase some limits**.



Business Scenario 1

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Business Scenario 1

Read the business scenario below and determine the most appropriate solutions for the company's requirements.



Cosmic Energy, a global leader in renewable energy solutions, is navigating through a period of rapid expansion and digital transformation. The company, renowned for its innovative approach to energy management and sustainability, is reevaluating its Salesforce org strategy to better align with its evolving business model, diverse customer base, and sprawling global operations. With the acquisition of several smaller companies in Europe and Asia, each with its own Salesforce org, the company faces the challenge of integrating these new entities into its existing infrastructure while ensuring that its Salesforce ecosystem can scale and adapt to the company's ambitious growth plans. The company's Salesforce architect is tasked with evaluating the current org strategy and proposing a roadmap that supports the company's business objectives, technical requirements, and architectural vision.

Requirements & Solutions

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Requirement (Part 1)



SCENARIO

The company requires suitable org strategies for different situations:

- ❖ Multiple Salesforce orgs are used for different lines of business (LOBs). The CTO wants to achieve a more comprehensive view of its customers by aggregating customer data from these disparate orgs.
- ❖ Several companies with their own Salesforce orgs were recently acquired and merged as new business units. They should have standardized business processes, but business process integration is not required.



Requirement (Part 2)



SCENARIO

- ❖ One of the newly acquired companies in Asia has a different sales process and needs to comply strictly with the local laws and regulations.
- ❖ The company wants to launch a new line of business for geothermal energy solutions in New Zealand that will have independent processes.



Solution (Part 1)



SOLUTION

- ❖ For a comprehensive view of customer data across multiple orgs, a **Hub-and-Spoke multi-org strategy** should be utilized. This involves consolidating customer data into a central org (hub) that aggregates information from other orgs (spokes). This centralized data hub ensures a unified customer view across different LOBs, facilitating better analytics, personalized customer engagement, and streamlined reporting without the need for complete process integration across all units.



Solution (Part 2)



SOLUTION

- ❖ For business units acquired with their own Salesforce orgs, where standardized business processes are crucial but integration between these processes is not necessary, a **multi-org strategy** should be utilized. A **managed package** or **a set of managed packages** can be developed to enforce standardized business processes across all the orgs. This would ensure consistency in operations while allowing each unit to operate independently in their Salesforce environment.



Solution (Part 3)



SOLUTION

- ❖ A **separate org** should be set up for the newly acquired company in Asia. Given the unique sales process and stringent local compliance requirements, maintaining a separate Salesforce org for this unit would allow for tailored configurations, localization, and adherence to local laws. This autonomy would ensure that the business unit can operate effectively within its regulatory environment while allowing for innovations specific to the regional market.



Solution (Part 4)



SOLUTION

- ❖ For the new geothermal energy solutions line of business in New Zealand, which requires independent processes, a **stand-alone org strategy** is the most suitable. This approach would allow the new business unit to develop and implement processes that are unique to its operations and market needs without being constrained by the existing org structures or processes. A stand-alone org would provide the flexibility needed to innovate and rapidly adapt to the unique challenges and opportunities of the geothermal energy market.



Business Scenario 2

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Business Scenario 2

Read the business scenario below and determine the most appropriate solutions for the company's requirements.



Cosmic Technologies, a leading innovator in the high-tech manufacturing sector, is undergoing significant organizational changes and technological advancements. This multinational corporation, known for its pioneering products and services, is confronting the complexities associated with managing multiple Salesforce orgs for its multiple lines of business (LOBs) around the globe. Each LOB operates independently with its own customized Salesforce org, tailored to local market needs.

It is currently going through a global organizational restructuring and review of its org strategies. The company's Salesforce architect is required to evaluate the current enterprise landscape and provide appropriate recommendations.

Requirements & Solutions

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Requirement (Part 1)



SCENARIO

The company has multiple lines of business (LOBs) with different orgs and processes but shares global customers. It has implemented a multi-org strategy with one org consolidating the customer data for a 360-degree view. However, since it wants to use Chatter to facilitate collaboration among the existing lines of business, it would like to switch to a single org despite the complexity of having multiple lines of business in a single org. The architect needs to provide the benefits and challenges of transitioning from a multi-org to a single-org strategy.



Requirement (Part 2)



SCENARIO

In addition, it is launching a new line of business that does not share customers with the existing lines of business and needs to implement unique business processes. A suitable org strategy is required for this new business unit.



Solution (Part 1)



SOLUTION

Switching from a multi-org to a single-org strategy has various benefits, including **reduced administration overhead**, **improved collaboration** among the different lines of business, and increased simplicity of creating a **360-degree view of customer data**. However, certain challenges need to be considered. **Apex design** must be **very mature** to support a large enterprise model. There should be a **strict separation of concerns**, and a technical architect should **oversee** all aspects of the org. **Managing the design and maintenance of the data model** is important, as it can become **much more complex and controversial** as the **scope** increases.



Solution (Part 2)



SOLUTION

For the new line of business that does not share its customers with others, **a new standalone Salesforce org** should be used. It should not be integrated with the other org due to its unique business processes.



Learn More

-  [Enterprise Architecture: Single-org versus Multi-org Strategy](#)
-  [Ask An Architect: Defining An Org Strategy, And Why You Need One](#)

